

# MAX ZHANG

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## Education

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**Irvington High School:** Class of 2027

**Unweighted GPA:** 3.97, **Weighted GPA:** 4.5

**Relevant Coursework:** AP Calculus BC, AP Physics 1, AP Computer Science A, AP Computer Science Principles, AP English Language and Composition, AP Psychology

## Experience

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**Stanford AI Measurement Science (AIMS) Lab**

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

*COLM Main Conference*

*Dec 2025 – Present*

- Working with Assistant Professor Sanmi Koyejo and PhD candidate Sang Truong in Stanford's AI Measurement Science (AIMS) lab.
- Built a multi-group Item Response Theory framework to decompose and measure cross-lingual safety vulnerabilities in LLMs.
- **Max Zhang\***, Ameen Patel\*, Sang Truong\*\*, Sanmi Koyejo\*\*, \*: Equal contribution, \*\*: Equal senior authorship. Paper accepted to COLM Main Conference. [\[arXiv\]](#) [\[code\]](#)

**Research Intern – Mechanistic Interpretability**

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

*Co-first Author*

*Dec 2025 – Present*

- Working with PhD candidate Nathan Hu to evaluate automated circuit tracing with Large Language Models.
- Extended Michael Hanna's open-source circuit tracing framework to automate the identification of interpretable circuits.
- Ameen Patel\*, **Max Zhang\***, Nathan Hu; \*: Equal contribution. Paper accepted to ICML Mechanistic Interpretability workshop. [\[OpenReview\]](#) [\[code\]](#)

**Beaver Works Summer Institute (BWSI)**

REMOTE

*Participant*

*July 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Selected for the Serious Games with AI (SGAI) BWSI program for July 6 – August 2, 2026.
- Only participant in SGAI course nominated for a paid Internship at [\[Draper Laboratory\]](#) next summer 2027. 1 of 14 students out of 500+ participants in 14 courses.

**AlgoVerse AI Research**

REMOTE

*Lead Author*

*June 2025 – Nov 2025*

- Paper accepted to NeurIPS 2025's Workshop on Socially Responsible Foundation Models and AACL-IJCNLP 2025's Student Research Workshop for **oral presentation**.
- **Max Zhang\***, Derek Liu, Kai Zhang, Joshua Franco, Haihao Liu; \*: Lead author. [\[arXiv\]](#)

## Projects

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**Badminton AI Form Tracker; June 2025 – April 2026:** Co-built BIRDIE; labeled 300–400 images of teammates' badminton form and built a Python CV pipeline (OpenCV/PyTorch; CNN + logistic regression) to detect player form, track birdie trajectory, and provide corrective feedback. [\[view\]](#)

**Code4Cause (BayHacks Winner); September 2024:** Developed a collaborative calendar web app using Firebase, JavaScript, and HTML, allowing non-profits to schedule events in real time. Our project won the Code4Cause track at BayHacks (1 of 10 winners out of 200+ participants). [\[devpost\]](#)

**Club Event Manager (BellHacks Winner); December 2025:** Built a centralized event management system for school clubs, outperforming 20+ teams and winning 2 PS5s. [\[devpost\]](#)

**Interactive Web; January 2025:** Self-led research project exploring how AI-driven code generation can simplify web development for novice programmers; co-authored with Kai Zhang and Vyom Kumar. [\[paper\]](#)

## Extracurricular Activities

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### Irvington Computer Science Club

*Co-President*

*Aug 2025 – Present*

- Lead organizer for Viking Hacks 2025 and 2026, one of Fremont’s largest student-led hackathons; managed logistics, judging, and sponsorship outreach. [\[link\]](#)
- Led weekly lectures on data structures and algorithms for 30+ club members.
- Runner-up at Viking Hacks 2024 in the “Future of Entertainment” category; Intern officer (2024 – 2025).

### AMC Theatres Part-time Job

NEWARK, CA

*Crew Member*

*August 2025 – Present*

- Handle high-volume guest service across ticketing, concessions, and ushering in a theater environment, often resolving customer issues directly.

### Silicon Valley Youth

FREMONT, CA

*Youth Badminton Instructor*

*2023 – 2025*

- Taught badminton fundamentals to grades 3–7 in groups of 10–20 students across three 8-week sessions. [\[legacy SVY link\]](#)

### Other clubs

- 2026–27 Irvington leadership roles: Secretary (Competitive Programming Club), Treasurer (Math Club), and Co-Founder (Movie Club).

## Honors & Awards

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- **USACO Gold Division:** Competitive Programming. USACO: Gold (Feb 2026); Silver (Dec 2024).
- **Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification:** Completed Andrew Ng’s Coursera course. [\[certificate\]](#)
- **Badminton (National Ranking):** U17 Boys Singles/Doubles #5 (2025); Pan American Championships U15 Boys Singles Runner-up (2023)
- **President’s Volunteer Service Award Gold (x2):** For sustained volunteer hours teaching badminton and tutoring English.
- **Stanford Math Tournament 2026:** Distinguished Honorable Mention in Guts/Team Rounds